



FULL-BLEED HERO PHOTOGRAPH
RECOMMENDED: MOUNT MAUNGANUI / TAURANGA HARBOUR

— YOUR JOURNEY BEGINS HERE

Bay of Plenty Relocation Guide

WRITTEN BY ETHICARE RESOURCING · TE MOANA-A-TOI



Kia ora, and a warm welcome to Aotearoa.

Kia ora, and a warm welcome to the Bay of Plenty — Te Moana-a-Toi, one of New Zealand's sunniest and fastest-growing regions.

Tauranga is the heart of the Bay: a coastal harbour city anchored by the iconic Mauao (Mount Maunganui), with white-sand beaches, a thriving port and a relaxed outdoor lifestyle. It is now New Zealand's fifth-largest city.

This guide covers housing, transport, healthcare, finances and where to explore on your days off.



Lifestyle / welcome photograph

RECOMMENDED: TAURANGA WATERFRONT OR FAMILY

Nau mai, haere mai ki Aotearoa! (Welcome to New Zealand!)

Ngā mihi nui,
The Ethicare Team

What's inside

01	Welcome & Overview	History, culture, transport and climate	04
02	Healthcare	The health system, GPs, pharmacies, urgent care	09
03	Banking & Finance	Bank accounts, IRD, KiwiSaver, getting paid	11
04	Cost of Living	Prices, an example budget & Sophie's insights	13
05	Housing & Areas	Renting and a guide to the suburbs	16
06	Shopping & Food	Malls, supermarkets, world food, worship	20
07	Recreation & Travel	Things to do, plus weekend trips	24
08	Education & Family	Schooling, zoning, childcare & family life	28
09	Practical Info	Checklists, emergencies, community & phrases	32

QUICK FACTS

LOCATION

Eastern North Island coast

CLIMATE

Warm, sunny, coastal

DRIVE TO AUCKLAND

~2.5 hours

MAIN CITY

Tauranga (~161,000)

MAIN HOSPITAL

Tauranga Hospital

NEARBY

Mount Maunganui, Rotorua

New Zealand's sunny coast

The Bay of Plenty curves along the eastern coast, blessed with some of the country's highest sunshine hours. Tauranga, its main city, has grown rapidly into a major centre for trade, horticulture and lifestyle.

161K

TAURANGA RESIDENTS

5th

LARGEST CITY IN NZ

2,200_{HRS}

SUNSHINE A YEAR – AMONG NZ'S
BEST

Why many professionals enjoy Bay of Plenty

- Among the sunniest regions in the country
- Beach and harbour living at Mount Maunganui
- A fast-growing economy and job market
- Easy reach of Rotorua's geothermal wonders

Coast, kiwifruit and community

The Bay of Plenty was named by Captain Cook for its abundance, and it remains a land of plenty – the heart of New Zealand's kiwifruit industry and home to strong Māori communities.

Mauao, the mountain at the tip of Mount Maunganui, is a sacred and much-loved landmark climbed by locals and visitors alike.

The region has a relaxed, beachy culture, with a busy summer festival calendar and a growing arts and dining scene around Tauranga's waterfront.



Cultural moment

RECOMMENDED: TAURANGA LANDMARK

“

Mauao watches over the bay – climb it once and you'll understand why locals never tire of the view.

ON LIFE IN BAY OF PLENTY

Getting around

Here is how people get around Bay of Plenty day to day – and what to know about driving in New Zealand.

DRIVING

A car is the main way to get around the spread-out region; State Highway 2 links the coastal towns.

BUSES

Tauranga's Bayhopper bus network serves the city and the Mount.

AIR

Tauranga Airport has frequent domestic flights to the main centres.

PORT

The Port of Tauranga is New Zealand's largest – a major regional employer.

On the road

- New Zealanders drive on the left
- You can usually drive on a valid overseas licence for up to 12 months before converting to a NZ one
- A local transport card makes buses and trains easy
- Keep your overseas licence and any translation handy when you first arrive

A year in the local climate

The Bay of Plenty lives up to its name with warm, sunny weather and one of the highest sunshine totals in New Zealand. Summers are hot and beachy; winters are mild.

Summer

DEC – FEB

22–27°

AVG DAYTIME

Autumn

MAR – MAY

18–22°

AVG DAYTIME

Winter

JUN – AUG

11–15°

AVG DAYTIME

Spring

SEP – NOV

16–21°

AVG DAYTIME



Seasonal / scenic photograph

RECOMMENDED: MAUAO / PAPAMOA BEACH

Long sunny summers make the beach a year-round draw. Bring sun protection and light clothing – and a light jacket for cooler winter evenings.

Healthcare in the Bay of Plenty

Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora delivers services across the bay, centred on Tauranga Hospital, with Whakatāne Hospital serving the eastern bay.

Tauranga Hospital

The region's main public hospital – a secondary regional centre (around 360 beds) with medical, surgical, maternity, paediatric and mental health services.

Whakatāne Hospital

Serves the eastern Bay of Plenty with acute, medical and maternity care.

Tertiary referrals

Complex cases are referred to Waikato Hospital in Hamilton, the region's tertiary centre.

Private & ACC

Grace Hospital in Tauranga is the bay's private surgical hospital; ACC covers accidents for everyone.

Public & private

- Public healthcare is funded through general taxation
- ACC provides no-fault accident cover for everyone
- Private hospitals offer elective procedures and shorter waits
- Many residents hold private health insurance alongside the public system

GPs, pharmacies & urgent care

Registering with a GP and dentist

After you settle in, enrol with a local GP (General Practitioner). Enrolment means subsidised visits — typically around NZ\$50–\$70 when enrolled, more if you are a casual patient. Many practices allow online enrolment once you have an address. Dental care is private; expect roughly NZ\$90–\$150 for a check-up.

Pharmacies

Pharmacies are found throughout the region. Prescriptions are partly subsidised once you are enrolled with a GP — commonly a small standard charge per item.

Emergency & after-hours

- **Emergency Departments** — for urgent or critical care; in an emergency, dial 111
- **Urgent care clinics** — accident & medical clinics offer extended-hours care
- **Healthline 0800 611 116** — free 24/7 advice from registered nurses

Setting up your finances

Getting your finances in order early makes day-to-day life much easier. Most of this can be started before you arrive.

Opening a bank account

The major banks are ANZ, ASB, BNZ, Kiwibank and Westpac. You will usually need your passport, work or resident visa, and proof of a NZ address. Many banks let you start online before arrival, then activate in person. Ask for online banking and a debit card at the same time.

Tax (IRD number)

Every worker needs an IRD number from Inland Revenue. Apply online once you have a NZ address and bank account; processing usually takes around 7–10 working days. Give the number to your payroll team as soon as it arrives so the correct tax is applied. Wages are commonly paid fortnightly.

● Tip

Start your bank account application before you fly — having an account number ready makes your IRD application and payroll setup much smoother.

KiwiSaver & sending money home

KiwiSaver is a government-supported retirement savings scheme. On a work visa you can usually opt in or out. Contributions are a percentage of your pay (commonly 3%, 4%, 6%, 8% or 10%), with employers contributing at least 3%. You can withdraw your funds if you permanently leave New Zealand.

Sending money overseas: banks can transfer internationally, but specialist services such as Wise or OFX are often cheaper and faster. Always compare the exchange rate and the fees before moving larger amounts.

SET UP	WHY IT MATTERS	WHEN
Bank account	Receive salary, pay bills locally	Before / on arrival
IRD number	Be taxed correctly	First weeks
KiwiSaver	Retirement savings + employer top-up	When you start work
ACC	No-fault accident cover	Automatic

What life costs in the Bay of Plenty

Tauranga's popularity has pushed housing costs up – they sit below Auckland but above smaller regions, balanced by the lifestyle and climate.

\$640/wk

3-BED HOUSE (APPROX. MEDIAN)

\$2.80/L

APPROX. PETROL PRICE

Left

SIDE OF THE ROAD

EVERYDAY ITEM	APPROX. PRICE (NZ\$)
1 litre of milk	\$2.50 – \$3.50
Loaf of bread	\$2.50 – \$4.00
Dozen eggs	\$7 – \$10
Flat white coffee	\$5.50 – \$6.50
Mid-range meal for one	\$25 – \$40
Monthly gym membership	\$60 – \$100
Home broadband	\$75 – \$100 / month

Prices are indicative and change over time – use the calculators at the back of this guide for a personalised estimate.

An example monthly budget

A rough single-person monthly budget for a Bay of Plenty renter. Yours will vary with lifestyle, household size and suburb.

CATEGORY	APPROX. MONTHLY (NZ\$)
Rent (room / small 1-bed)	\$1,500 – \$2,300
Power & water	\$150 – \$220
Internet	\$75 – \$100
Public transport / fuel	\$160 – \$280
Groceries	\$450 – \$650
Mobile phone	\$30 – \$50
Entertainment	\$200 – \$380
Estimated total	\$2,600 – \$3,900

Make it personal

- Use Numbeo to compare Bay of Plenty with your current city
- Map your own incomings and outgoings with the Sorted budget planner (sorted.org.nz)

A note from Sophie

A personal word from our Founder on what makes Bay of Plenty special — and who it tends to suit.



● SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

If you ask people why they move to Tauranga, the answer is almost always the same: the beach and the sun. It's a genuinely beautiful place to live, and the job market has grown up fast alongside the city.

Housing has caught up in price, so it pays to plan — but for a coastal, outdoors life, few places compare.

Sophie Careem · Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing

● From the Ethicare team

Your Ethicare contact is here to help with every step of your move to Bay of Plenty — from accommodation to payroll setup. Reach out any time.

Finding a place to live

From beachside apartments at the Mount to suburban family homes and lifestyle blocks, the Bay offers coastal living in many forms.



Housing / suburb photograph

RECOMMENDED: SUBURBAN STREET OR APARTMENTS

Useful property websites

- trademe.co.nz/property – NZ's largest rental marketplace
- realestate.co.nz – nationwide rentals and homes for sale

A guide to the areas

An orientation to the main areas of Bay of Plenty — each with its own character, price point and who it tends to suit.

Mount Maunganui

Beachside apartments and townhouses by Mauao and the surf — sought-after and priced accordingly.

Tauranga city & Otumoetai

Central and harbourside suburbs handy to the CBD and hospital.

Papamoa

A fast-growing coastal suburb popular with families, with long beaches and new builds.

Bethlehem & Pyes Pā

Leafy western suburbs with good schools and shopping.

Across the wider region

Mount Maunganui

Beachside living by Mauao and the surf — the bay's most sought-after spot.

Papamoa

Long beaches and new family subdivisions, fast-growing and popular.

Te Puke & Katikati

Affordable kiwifruit-country towns within commuting distance.

Whakatāne

The sunny eastern bay hub with its own hospital and beaches.

A tip on choosing

- Think about your commute to work and school zones if you have children
- Where you live can decide which state school your children attend — check the zone before you sign
- Many people rent for a few months first to get to know the areas

Utilities, rates & rubbish

POWER & GAS

Choose from providers like Genesis, Mercury, Meridian and Contact. Compare rates on Powerswitch (powerswitch.org.nz).

WATER & RATES

Council rates fund local services; if you rent, rates are usually included in your rent.

RUBBISH & RECYCLING

Kerbside collection is run by the local council, with separate bins for rubbish, recycling and food scraps.

INTERNET

Most homes have fibre broadband; Spark, One NZ and 2degrees are the main providers.

Set-up quick links

Compare power

powerswitch.org.nz

Post & parcels

nzpost.co.nz

Tenancy advice

tenancy.govt.nz

Where to shop

Bay of Plenty offers malls, town centres and weekend markets. A few of the main ones:

Bayfair (Mount Maunganui)

The region's largest mall, recently expanded, near the beach.

Tauranga Crossing

A modern open-air shopping centre in the western suburbs.

Tauranga CBD & The Strand

The waterfront dining strip and central shopping.

Markets

The Mount and Tauranga farmers' markets for local produce.

Supermarkets & groceries

New Zealand's supermarkets fall into a few main groups. Knowing the difference helps you balance budget and convenience.

Pak'nSave

The cheapest of the big chains — a no-frills, bulk-buy warehouse format. Best for budget shopping.

Woolworths

Mid-range and widespread, with strong online shopping and delivery (formerly Countdown).

New World

More upmarket, with a wider fresh and specialty range.

Four Square & FreshChoice

Smaller neighbourhood stores for convenience and top-ups.

Tauranga has Pak'nSave, Woolworths and New World across the city; smaller towns have New World and Four Square. Bring your own bags — single-use plastic bags are banned.

Specialty & international food

One of the joys of settling into Bay of Plenty is finding the flavours of home — or exploring new ones.

Halal & South Asian

Halal and Indian grocers serve Tauranga's growing community; many supermarket lines are halal-certified.

Asian groceries

Asian supermarkets and restaurants cluster around the CBD and Bethlehem.

World food

A growing, diverse food scene reflecting the bay's rapid population growth.

Smaller independent stores open and close over time — a quick search for "halal butcher near me" or your home cuisine will surface the current options near your suburb.

Places of worship

Bay of Plenty reflects New Zealand's spiritual diversity, with welcoming communities across many faiths.

Tauranga has Christian churches of many denominations, a mosque, and Hindu and Buddhist communities, with more across the bay.

Finding your community

- Most faith communities list service times and locations online
- Many warmly welcome newcomers and visitors
- They can be one of the quickest ways to build a support network when you arrive

Beach life, all year round

The Bay of Plenty is built for the outdoors – surf, harbour, hot pools and the gateway to Rotorua's geothermal playground.



Recreation hero photograph

RECOMMENDED: MAUAO / PAPAMOA BEACH

Don't-miss experiences

- Climb or walk around Mauao at the Mount
- Surf and swim the long beaches at Papamoa
- Soak at Mount Hot Pools after a beach day
- Day-trip to Rotorua's geysers and mud pools

Ten things not to miss

A starter list to get to know Bay of Plenty and the wider region.

- 1 Climb Mauao**
The iconic Mount Maunganui summit walk.
- 2 Mount Hot Pools**
Soak in saltwater hot pools at the foot of Mauao.
- 3 Papamoa Beach**
Endless white sand for swimming and surfing.
- 4 McLaren Falls Park**
Bush walks and glow-worms near the city.
- 5 Tauranga waterfront**
The Strand and the harbour boardwalk.
- 6 White Island viewing**
See NZ's active marine volcano from the coast.
- 7 Kaiate Falls**
A series of swimming holes and waterfalls.
- 8 Te Puna & Katikati**
Country drives, art and the kiwifruit heartland.
- 9 Ōmokoroa**
A peaceful peninsula with harbour walks.
- 10 Rotorua day trip**
Geothermal wonders an hour inland.

Travel from Tauranga

Bay of Plenty is a great base for exploring. Some favourite weekend escapes:

Rotorua (~1 hr)

Geysers, hot springs and Māori culture.

Whakatāne & Ōhope (~1.5 hrs)

NZ's sunniest spot and a beautiful beach.

Coromandel (~2 hrs)

Cathedral Cove and Hot Water Beach.

Taupō (~1.5 hrs)

The great lake, trout fishing and Huka Falls.

Flying onward

- Domestic flights reach the main centres in around 1–2 hours
- Book early for the best fares on Air New Zealand and Jetstar
- Many regions are also linked by scenic road and rail journeys

Schooling & study

Bay of Plenty offers a full range of early childhood education, schools and tertiary study.

Early Childhood Education (ECE)

Kindergartens, daycare, Montessori, kōhanga reo and home-based care for ages 0–5. Government 20-hours funding applies for ages 3–5.

Primary & intermediate

State, state-integrated and private schools for Years 1–8.

Secondary

Years 9–13, working towards NCEA, the national qualification.

Tertiary

Universities and institutes of technology across the country.

School terms run late January to mid-December, in four terms with two-week breaks in April, July and October.

School zones come first

In New Zealand, where you live usually determines which state school your children can attend. For many families, the school decision leads the choice of where to rent or buy.

In-zone = guaranteed

Children living inside a school's enrolment zone are guaranteed a place at that school.

Out-of-zone = ballot

If you live outside the zone you can still apply, but places aren't guaranteed – popular schools run a ballot for limited spots.

Zones are street-by-street

Boundaries can run down the middle of a street, so check the exact address.

● **The order that works best**

1) Shortlist schools you like → 2) Check each school's zone map → 3) Search for rentals inside that zone → 4) Confirm the address is in-zone before you sign.

Childcare for working families

Early childhood (0–5). Daycare, kindergartens, Montessori and home-based care are widely available. The government's 20 Hours ECE funding subsidises care for ages 3–5 at participating centres.

Before & after school (OSCAR). Many schools and providers run breakfast clubs, after-school care and holiday programmes. Subsidies may be available through Work and Income for eligible families.

TYPE OF CARE	APPROX. COST (NZ\$)
Full-time daycare (under 3)	\$350 – \$450 / week before subsidies
20 Hours ECE (ages 3–5)	Up to 20 hrs/week subsidised; extra hours charged
After-school care (OSCAR)	\$5 – \$15 per afternoon, varies by provider
School holiday programme	\$40 – \$60 per day, activity-based

Costs are indicative and vary by provider and suburb. If you'll work shifts, ask providers about flexible hours.

Bay of Plenty for families

Beyond school and work, Bay of Plenty is an easy, outdoorsy place to raise a family.

FREE & OUTDOORS

Beaches, Mauao walks and waterfront playgrounds — much of the fun is free.

RAINY-DAY OPTIONS

The Classic Flyers museum, Adrenalin Forest and indoor play centres.

LIBRARIES & PLUNKET

Free libraries run children's programmes; Plunket supports young families.

GETTING AROUND

A relaxed coastal region — short drives between beaches and parks.

Settling kids in

- Children often settle fastest through school, sport and weekend activities
- Local clubs — football, netball, rugby, swimming — are inexpensive and welcoming
- They're a great way for the whole family to meet people

Pre-departure checklist

Work through these before you fly. Keep digital and printed copies of everything important.

Documents

- ☐ Passport + valid NZ visa (printed too)
- ☐ Job offer & employment contract
- ☐ Qualifications & certificates
- ☐ References & employment history

Money & travel

- ☐ Apply online for a NZ bank account
- ☐ Documents ready for your IRD number
- ☐ Confirm airline baggage allowance
- ☐ Book temporary accommodation

Your first weeks

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Move into your accommodation | ☐ Open / activate your bank account |
| ☐ Apply for your IRD number | ☐ Get a NZ SIM card |
| ☐ Register with a local GP | ☐ Set up power, water and internet |
| ☐ Learn your transport routes to work | ☐ Save 111 and Healthline in your phone |
| ☐ Find your nearest pharmacy & supermarket | ☐ Explore your local neighbourhood |

● You're not alone

Your Ethicare contact is here to help with any of these steps – from accommodation to payroll setup. Reach out any time.

Key numbers & contacts

In any emergency – police, fire or ambulance – dial **111**.

Emergency & health

Emergency	111
Healthline	0800 611 116
Mental health	Call/text 1737
Police (non-urgent)	105

Everyday services

Tax (IRD)	ird.govt.nz
Immigration	immigration.govt.nz
AA roadside	0800 500 222
Local council	govt.nz/organisations

Banks

ANZ	anz.co.nz
ASB	asb.co.nz
BNZ	bnz.co.nz
Kiwibank	kiwibank.co.nz
Westpac	westpac.co.nz

Community & expat groups

One of the quickest ways to settle in is to find your people. Bay of Plenty has active communities for almost every interest and background.

Facebook groups

Search for groups like "Expats in Bay of Plenty", your home-country community, and local suburb buy/sell and parents' groups.

Meetup & interest groups

Meetup.com lists hiking, sport, hobby and newcomer groups — a relaxed way to meet people.

Sports & cultural clubs

Local football, netball, rugby and cricket clubs, plus cultural and faith communities, all welcome newcomers.

Workplace networks

Many hospitals and employers have social clubs and buddy systems for new and international staff.

Rainbow / LGBTQ+ community

- New Zealand is welcoming and progressive — marriage equality has been law since 2013
- There are strong legal protections against discrimination
- OutLine Aotearoa offers rainbow mental-health support (0800 688 5463)

Everyday Māori & Kiwi phrases

Te reo Māori is part of everyday life, and Kiwis have their own slang too.

Te reo Māori

Kia ora Hello / thanks

Nau mai, haere mai Welcome

Whānau Family

Hauora Health & wellbeing

Manaakitanga Hospitality, kindness

Mōrena Good morning

Ka kite anō See you later

Tamariki Children

Ngā mihi nui Many thanks

Aotearoa New Zealand

Kiwi slang

Sweet as Great / no worries

Keen Up for it

Dairy Corner shop

Jandals Flip-flops

Flatting Shared renting

Chur Cheers / thanks

Heaps Lots

Togs Swimwear

Shout Your turn to pay

Knackered Tired

Work out your cost of living.

Use these tools to estimate what life in Bay of Plenty would really cost for you and your family.

Cost-of-living calculators

Compare cities (Numbeo)	numbeo.com/cost-of-living
Budget planner (Sorted)	sorted.org.nz/tools/budget-planner
Living-costs data (Stats NZ)	stats.govt.nz
Take-home pay (IRD)	ird.govt.nz

We hope you've found this guide useful. Moving to the other side of the world is a big step, and there's a lot to take in – so please don't feel you have to have it all figured out at once.

Whatever stage you're at, we're always happy to talk anything through – the big decisions or the small worries. Just reach out to your Ethicare contact whenever you need us.

Ngā mihi nui

The Ethicare team



ETHICARE RESOURCING

Ethicare Resourcing Ltd

Office 1, One Coldbath Square, London, EC1R 5HL · Company No: 14646354

T +44 7375 019 544 · **E** hello@ethicareresourcing.com · **W** www.ethicareresourcing.com